U1 The path to modernization

Unit overview

Modernization, generally defined as the transformation of a society from traditional to contemporary ways of living, is a social phenomenon with a far-reaching impact on everyone's life. This process manifests through expanded economic opportunities, reshaped social structures, advanced educational systems, and new pathways for career development and personal advancement. This unit explores modernization through diverse perspectives, offering insights into both China's remarkable progress and global parallels. The Understanding China section examines China's modernization journey through major transportation projects in western China and the evolution of the Spring Festival. Exploring the world focuses on Germany's modernization. These diverse perspectives can help Ss appreciate how each society charts its own distinctive path to modernization, shaped by its unique culture, values, and circumstances. Additionally, in Communicating with the world, Ss are asked to write an essay showcasing China's modernization achievements, which can help them foster a deeper understanding of China's progress of modernization and its global impact.

思政元素清单

Understanding China — Viewing

- 中国式现代化是全体人民共同富裕的现代化。
- 小康路上不让任何一地因交通而掉队。
- 目标明确，排除万难。

Understanding China — Reading

- 中国式现代化是人口规模巨大的现代化，是物质文明和精神文明相协调的现代化，是人与自然和谐共生的现代化。
- 中国式现代化的成果体现在生活的方方面面，由人民共享。
- 传统文化在现代化进程中实现创造性转化、创新性发展。

Exploring the world — Reading

- 各国现代化历程既有共性，也有个性，道路因国情而异。
- 国际合作可以带来发展和进步。
- 科技进步和创新是现代化的不竭动力。

单元开篇

Quote

中国式现代化是人口规模巨大的现代化……是全体人民共同富裕的现代化……是物质文明和精神文明相协调的现代化……是人与自然和谐共生的现代化……是走和平发展道路的现代化。

——2022 年 10 月 16 日，习近平在中国共产党第二十次全国代表大会上的报告

Key facts about China

The key facts in this unit are closely related to the five characteristics of Chinese modernization mentioned in the quote. Each key fact illustrates how China embodies one or two aspects of these characteristics, helping learners understand the scale, complexity, and approach of Chinese modernization within a global context. Here's how the selected key facts connect to the quote:

Key fact 1: This fact highlights the characteristic of "the modernization of a huge population." The comparison with the total population of developed countries helps Ss understand the unprecedented magnitude of Chinese modernization and emphasizes why China must forge its own unique path rather than simply follow existing models.

Key fact 2: This fact demonstrates both the characteristics of "the modernization of common prosperity for all" and "the modernization of material and cultural-ethical advancement." The statistics show how modernization has enhanced the quality of life for the entire population through both material improvements and cultural-ethical progress.

Key fact 3: This fact illustrates the characteristic of "the modernization of harmony between humanity and nature." The commitment demonstrates how China's modernization path prioritizes environmental sustainability alongside economic development.

Key fact 4: This fact corresponds to the characteristic of "the modernization of peaceful development." By embedding this principle into its constitution, China reinforces its commitment to advancing its own development while fostering a stable international environment.

*** T can guide Ss to access the digital textbook for the latest information and data on Ucampus.**

Teaching suggestions

The following steps help Ss develop a nuanced understanding of modernization as both a universal concept and a culturally specific process, positioning China's experience within a global context while highlighting its distinctive features. The sequence then transitions from

theoretical framework to tangible impact on everyday life, naturally engaging Ss' interest while preparing them for the unit project.

Step 1: Begin by introducing the unit title. Ask Ss to briefly discuss what modernization means and brainstorm countries that have made remarkable achievements on the path to modernization. Highlight that while modernization is a universal goal, China's approach is unique and represents a significant milestone in human history. Guide Ss to examine the quote of the unit, highlighting the five features of Chinese modernization.

Step 2: Have Ss review the key facts about China's modernization. Organize them into small groups to discuss which aspect of Chinese modernization is reflected in each fact.

Step 3: Encourage Ss to brainstorm additional aspects of modernization beyond the given facts. Guide them to consider infrastructure development, technological innovation, income growth, etc. Use Scenario to stimulate creative thinking about how these dimensions manifest in real-life experiences and contribute to China's unique modernization narrative.

Step 4: Outline the unit's learning objectives and explain how they help Ss complete the task in Scenario. This unit enables Ss to appreciate how modernization unfolds globally and enhances cross-cultural understanding through data presentation methods and past-present comparisons.

Understanding China

The two materials in this section offer complementary perspectives on Chinese modernization. The Viewing section focuses on major transportation infrastructure projects in western China, providing a localized perspective through concrete examples. Through vivid descriptions of the challenging environment and the transformative impact on local communities, the video demonstrates China's commitment to ensuring that even the most remote regions participate in high-quality development. The Reading section takes a more relatable approach by examining the evolution of the Spring Festival, a cultural phenomenon central to Chinese society. Through exploring changes in travel patterns, celebration methods, and entertainment forms, the text reveals how this traditional festival adapts to China's modernization journey. This dual perspective helps Ss understand how modernization manifests in both significant national projects and everyday life experiences, and in both national and localized transformation.

These materials effectively illustrate multiple characteristics of Chinese modernization as proposed by President Xi. The video powerfully demonstrates "the modernization of common prosperity for all" through its focus on regional development, while the text showcases several aspects: "the modernization of material and cultural-ethical advancement" through diversified entertainment options, "the modernization of harmony between humanity and nature" through the shift from firecrackers to drone performances, and "the modernization of a huge population" through better transportation options that resonate with all Chinese people.

The key point in Understanding China is helping Ss understand China's modernization efforts and achievements. The difficult point is helping Ss develop effective intercultural communication strategies to convey China's unique modernization story to a global audience. While modernization is a familiar concept to Ss, the task lies in presenting China's distinct experience in ways that are both authentic and accessible to international readers.

Viewing

Before viewing

Sample answers

1

Based on my travel experience, Chinese transportation infrastructure can be described as modern, efficient, and extensive. Most mid-sized cities nowadays are connected through high-speed railways, making travel incredibly convenient and time-efficient. I recently traveled from Beijing to Wuhan on a bullet train and was impressed by not only the train's smooth operation at 300 km/h but also the seamless integration of digital services – from purchasing tickets on my phone to using facial recognition for boarding. The railway station itself was like a small city, with clear signage in multiple languages and convenient connections to the local underground system.

The excellence of Chinese infrastructure is also praised by many foreign tourists traveling to China for the first time. I recently watched some vloggers sharing their experiences on social media, and they were particularly impressed by the ultra-modern transportation China has. One British travel vlogger documented his first ride on a Chinese bullet train, expressing genuine surprise at the spacious seating, spotless carriages, and the surreal experience of watching the landscape blur past his window at 350 km/h while his coffee cup remained perfectly still on the table. These testimonials remind me how fortunate we are to witness such remarkable progress in our country's infrastructure development, which has transformed the way we travel and live.

Scripts

With a total length of 435 kilometers and more than 90 percent of the line being above 3,000 meters above sea level, the Lhasa-Nyingchi railway is the first electrified railway in southwest China's Xizang, "the roof of the world." As an important part of the Sichuan-Xizang Railway, the Lhasa-Nyingchi Railway has facilitated Tibetan people's travel, boosted employment and entrepreneurship, and promoted industrial development since it was put into operation. Enabling more convenient goods shipment and attracting more inflows of visitors and traders, the Lhasa-Nyingchi Railway has given rise to the plateau's vitality with its operation. Local specialties such as matsutake, Tibetan chickens, and Tibetan pigs from Nyingchi are making forays into markets across the country.

The Hotan-Ruoqiang Railway, located around the southern rim of the world's second-largest shifting desert, Taklimakan, was put into operation in mid-June [2022] in northwest China's Xinjiang Uygur Autonomous Region. This marks the completion of a closed loop of the 2,712-kilometer Xinjiang railway encircling the Taklimakan, which is the world's first desert rail loop line.

Also in Xinjiang, builders overcome many challenges such as complex terrains and cold climate to build Xinjiang's first super-high plateau airport and successfully completed its test flight. The Taxkorgan Airport is surrounded by mountains on three sides, with peaks of up to 6,000 meters. When the airport opens to traffic, it will greatly shorten the travel time for people in remote areas. Alaer Tarim Airport, China's first airport built in collapsible desert areas, also began operation in mid-June. Passengers in the southern Xinjiang city can transit through Urumqi in northern Xinjiang and reach cities such as Beijing and Shenzhen on the same day.

Over the past decade, China has accelerated the formation of a comprehensive transportation network, focusing on shoring up the weak areas in the western regions and fulfilling the solemn promise that "no place will be left behind due to poor traffic on the road to a moderately prosperous society". From 2012 to the end of 2021, the mileage of China's railways and highways increased by about 1.1 million kilometers, which is equivalent to 27.5 laps around the Earth's equator. With the high-speed train traveling on "the roof of the world", songs singing the happy life could be heard far and wide. One infrastructure miracle after

another, Chinese contractors are making the country's transportation network an even more sophisticated painting.

Language points

1. **As an important part of the Sichuan-Xizang Railway, the Lhasa-Nyingchi Railway has facilitated Tibetan people's travel, boosted employment and entrepreneurship, and promoted industrial development since it was put into operation. (Para. 1)**

put sth. into operation: when you put a rule, system, or plan into operation, you begin to use it 实施；将…投入使用

The power plant will be put into operation by the end of this year.

Note: The sentence demonstrates effective use of parallel structure through three elements that share the auxiliary verb "has." The parallel structure creates a pleasing rhythm and builds to a climax. This technique is commonly used to present multiple related points with equal emphasis.

2. **Local specialties such as matsutake, Tibetan chickens, and Tibetan pigs from Nyingchi are making forays into markets across the country. (Para. 1)**

make forays into sth.:

1) make a short attempt at doing a particular job or activity, esp. one that is very different from what you usu. do （尤对某项非本行的工作或活动）短暂尝试

   The tech giant is making forays into the healthcare industry.

2) (*literal*) make a sudden, brief attack or raid into an area 突袭；侵略

   The army made forays into enemy territory during the night.

3. **This marks the completion of a closed loop of the 2,712-kilometer Xinjiang railway encircling the Taklimakan, which is the world's first desert rail loop line. (Para. 2)**

Note: The structure "This marks + noun phrase (often with the article 'the') + of + longer descriptive phrase" is often used to announce or highlight a significant achievement, milestone, or turning point. It is commonly used in news reports, official announcements, and academic writing.

4. **Over the past decade, China has accelerated the formation of a comprehensive transportation network, focusing on shoring up the weak areas in the western regions … (Para. 4)**

shore up: help or support sth. that is likely to fail or is not working well 加强 (similar expressions: bolster, reinforce, strengthen)

The company introduced innovative strategies to shore up its market share in the face of growing competition.

Viewing and understanding

Reference answers

2

1; 3; 4; 6; 7; 9; 10

Intercultural communication skill

Teaching suggestions

The following steps help Ss understand the importance of data in building persuasive arguments. They aim to teach Ss how to present statistics in an engaging and meaningful way, and identify reliable sources for credible information.

- Lead a brief class discussion and guide Ss to think about why the use of data in the video is important.
- Emphasize that each piece of data needs to contribute meaningfully to the argument. Ask Ss to explain the rationale for selecting specific numbers in the video and their broader significance.
- Emphasize the value of highlighting significant characteristics in data presentation, such as "first" and "largest," and demonstrate how to make data more relatable through creative comparisons, like equating transportation network growth to "27.5 laps around the Earth's equator."
- Guide Ss toward reliable data sources, including official government statistics bureaus, recognized international organizations, and reputable research institutions.
- Warn against common pitfalls such as using outdated statistics or overwhelming readers with too many numbers.

*** Remind Ss to access the video micro-lecture in the digital textbook to learn more about the skill on Ucampus.**

Sample answers

3

The video presents several key pieces of data.

- Lhasa-Nyingchi Railway:

  a total length of 435 kilometers

  more than 90 percent of the line being above 3,000 meters above sea level

  the first electrified railway in southwest China's Xizang

- Hotan-Ruoqiang Railway:

  located around the southern rim of the world's second largest shifting desert

  a closed loop of the 2,712-kilometer Xinjiang railway

  the world's first desert rail loop line
- Taxkorgan Airport:

  Xinjiang's first super-high plateau airport

  Surrounded by peaks of up to 6,000 meters
- Alaer Tarim Airport:

  China's first airport built in collapsible desert areas
- China's railway and highway growth (2012-2021):

  about 1.1 million kilometers, which is equivalent to 27.5 laps around the Earth's equator

Story of China's infrastructure miracle:

China's infrastructure advancements in challenging regions are a testament to its modernization efforts. The 435-kilometer Lhasa-Nyingchi Railway, the first electrified railway in Xizang, operates above 3,000 meters and has enhanced travel, industrial development, and goods shipment. Local products like matsutake and Tibetan chickens now reach markets across the country, supporting regional economic growth.

In Xinjiang, the 2,712-kilometer Hotan-Ruoqiang Railway, completed in June 2022, is the world's first desert rail loop line, boosting connectivity and trade around the Taklimakan Desert. Additionally, Taxkorgan Airport, built on a high plateau with peaks of up to 6,000 meters, shortens travel time for people in remote areas. The Alaer Tarim Airport, operational from June 2022, facilitates easy access to major cities.

From 2012 to 2021, China's railways and highways expanded by 1.1 million kilometers, equivalent to 27.5 laps around the Earth's equator, enhancing national connectivity and supporting economic development. These projects demonstrate China's commitment to modernizing its infrastructure and ensuring no region is left behind, driving growth and improving quality of life for millions.

Reading

Text: The allure of modern Spring Festival

Background information

Modernization is a comprehensive topic that touches virtually every aspect of daily life. The Spring Festival, as an equally all-encompassing traditional event, offers a compelling lens

through which to examine various dimensions of Chinese modernization. The text mainly focuses on three dimensions: transportation, celebration and entertainment, exploring the infrastructure, technological and economic development behind these changes. T can guide Ss to discuss in depth through more detailed examples.

For instance, the effective management of the world's largest annual human migration exemplifies China's transformative achievements in transportation infrastructure. The comprehensive national transportation network now exceeds 6 million kilometers, positioning China at the forefront of global mobility and connectivity. The increasingly convenient holiday shopping and dining experiences testify to China's advancements in digital technologies, one of the many shining examples of technological advancement. China has made breakthroughs in some core technologies in key fields, including manned spaceflight, lunar and Martian exploration, deep sea and deep Earth probes, and supercomputers, joining the ranks of the world's innovators. The diverse and colorful entertainment activities, including robust domestic tourism and cinema growth, reflect the boom in cultural industries and the strengthening of cultural confidence. The reduction of firecrackers symbolizes China's commitment to environmental sustainability. The overall environmental efforts have helped China rank among the world's leaders in energy intensity reduction. These multifaceted changes during the Spring Festival illustrate some of China's modernization achievements, highlighting the nation's ongoing journey toward a more prosperous, technologically advanced, and sustainable future.

Notes

***T can guide Ss to study the multimodal annotations in the digital textbook on Ucampus.**

Language points

1 For Chinese families, the Spring Festival is the crown jewel of the cultural calendar. (Para. 1)

the crown jewel: (or **the jewel in the crown**) the best or most valuable thing that a person or place has 最为宝贵的东西
The Taj Mahal is the crown jewel of Indian architecture.

Note: This metaphor effectively elevates Spring Festival to something precious and central to Chinese culture, conveying its supreme cultural significance in a vivid image.

2 People faced long lines for tickets, cobbled together train and bus trips, and ended up walking a great deal, too. (Para. 2)

cobble sth. together: make sth. quickly and without a lot of care, using whatever is available 匆忙拼凑
I just had to cobble this meal together from what I had in the fridge.

end up: be in a particular situation, state, or place after a series of events, esp. when you did not plan it （尤指经历一系列意外后）最终处于，到头来

He ignored the warning signs and ended up getting lost in the forest.

Note: These phrases vividly portray the challenging travel experience: "cobbled together" suggests improvised, imperfect transportation arrangements, while "ended up walking" conveys the unplanned, often exhausting conclusion to these journeys, effectively capturing the difficulties travelers faced.

3 Today, that landscape has been redrawn with the bold strokes of progress. (Para. 3)

Meaning: Transportation has fundamentally changed through major developments and improvements.

Note: This sentence employs a painting metaphor, comparing China's transportation transformation to a picture that has been redrawn. The use of the word "bold" underscores the decisive and impactful nature of these changes, conveying a sense of confidence and vision in shaping the future.

4 China's high-speed rail network, already covering over 48,000 kilometers and connecting 96 percent of mid-sized cities, has revolutionized travel, shrinking vast distances into mere hours. (Para. 3)

Note: The phrase "shrinking vast distances into mere hours" vividly illustrates the dramatic improvement in travel efficiency. As change is a recurring theme throughout the text, various expressions illustrating changes can also be found, such as "has now become," "has been replaced by," "transforming … into," "instead of," "has traded … for ...," etc.

"Mid-sized cities" here refers to cities with populations over 500,000.

5 For those who prefer wheels to wings, car travel has become increasingly popular, thanks to China's well-maintained highway network (the world's largest at over 5 million kilometers), which weaves through bustling metropolises and tranquil rural areas alike, offering convenient access to hometowns across the country. (Para. 3)

bustling: *a.* (of a place) full of activity （地方）繁忙的，热闹的

The café was bustling with customers on a Saturday afternoon, with laughter and chatter filling the air.

tranquil: *a.* pleasantly calm, quiet, and peaceful 平静的；宁静的

The lake was tranquil at sunrise, without a ripple disturbing its glassy surface.

Note: The words "bustling" and "tranquil" are antonyms used here to emphasize the comprehensive coverage of China's highway network, highlighting how it connects both urban and rural areas. This use of contrasting words to convey completeness appears elsewhere in the text as well, such as in "relatives who journey from far and near (Para. 2)".

Contrasting words are also effectively used to create powerful past-present comparisons. Here are some examples:
*Air travel, once a **luxury**, has now become **commonplace** ...* (Para. 3)
*... reflecting a society that has traded **hardship** for **comfort**, **scarcity** for **abundance**, and **simplicity** for **sophistication**.* (Para. 8)

6 With just a few taps on a phone screen, holiday preparations can now take care of themselves. (Para. 4)

Meaning: Holiday preparations have become so convenient and automated that they can be easily managed through mobile devices with minimal effort.

Note: The phrase "take care of themselves" uses personification by attributing human qualities (self-management) to an abstract concept (holiday preparations).

7 E-commerce giants have rolled out "non-stop shopping" campaigns, transforming the pre-festival rush into a leisurely scroll through digital aisles. (Para. 4)

roll out: launch or introduce sth. new, esp. a product or service 推出
The company plans to roll out its new line of electric vehicles across international markets next year.

8 Now, friends of all ages exchange virtual red envelopes, adding a fresh spin to the holiday fun. (Para. 5)

Note: In this sentence, the word "spin" refers to a new or innovative twist or change to a traditional practice or concept. Other examples:
The director's latest movie adds a modern spin to the classic Shakespearean tragedy.
The festival organizers put an exciting spin on the event with live drone shows.

9 The evolution of the Spring Festival mirrors China's breathtaking journey of modernization, reflecting a society that has traded hardship for comfort, scarcity for abundance, and simplicity for sophistication. (Para. 8)

Note: This sentence uses three parallel contrasts to capture the comprehensive improvement in Chinese people's quality of life. Beyond specific Spring Festival activities, it conveys how modernization has transformed daily existence across all dimensions – creating more comfortable living conditions, abundant resources and opportunities, and sophisticated lifestyles throughout Chinese society.

Translation

现代春节的魅力

1 对中国家庭而言，春节是文化日历中的璀璨明珠。我们曾睁大眼睛聆听母亲讲述乘坐拥挤火车回家的传奇故事，倾听父亲描绘热闹非凡的集市，以及在蒸气腾腾的厨房里准备盛宴的场景。祖父母也分享过鞭炮响彻夜空伴随阵阵欢笑的回忆。

随着中国在现代化道路上快速前行，这一备受喜爱的节日也展现出了全新的面貌。春节，这个曾经以家庭团聚为核心的节日，如今已转变为融合传统与 21 世纪进步的多元化体验。

2 春节最珍贵的主题之一是阖家欢聚，吸引着四面八方的亲人踏上归家之旅。在过去，回家的过程常常充满艰辛。人们要排长队购票，辗转搭乘火车和汽车，还要步行很长距离。

3 如今，这一景象已被进步的画笔重新大胆描绘。中国的高铁网络覆盖超过 48,000 公里，连接了 96%的中型城市，彻底改变了出行方式，将遥远的距离压缩为短短几小时。曾经奢侈的航空出行，如今已成为日常。全国 260 多个机场每天运营 13,000 多趟国内航班。对于更喜欢公路旅行的人来说，自驾游日益流行，中国完善的公路网络（总长度超过500万公里，居世界首位）贯穿繁华都市和宁静乡村，为返乡之路提供便利。而最令人瞩目的变化，也许是购票方式的悄然革新。人们裹着厚重衣物在寒风中排队等候的景象，已被智能手机屏幕的光芒取代，数百万用户只需简单点击几下就能轻松购票，让回家的旅途如团聚般温暖。

4 科技不仅重塑了出行方式，也丰富了春节庆祝活动，满足每个人的独特偏好。年货市场依旧繁荣，为热衷传统购物的人提供了一场感官盛宴。然而，伴随着这熟悉的场景，一个充满便利的新世界已悄然兴起。只需在手机上轻轻一点，节日准备就能轻松完成。电商巨头推出“年货不打烊”活动，让匆忙的节前采购变成轻松的线上浏览。快递公司依托数字化、自动化和无人技术，确保订单以令人惊叹的速度送达。想象一下：美味牛羊肉从宁夏的阳光牧场穿越超过一千公里的距离到达沿海城市的餐桌，仅需不到 24 小时。

5 年夜饭也随现代生活的多样化节奏和口味发生了转变。对于钟爱家常菜的人来说，厨房依旧是创造香甜记忆的圣地。而对于时间紧张或想尝试新事物的人来说，点外卖或外出就餐的选择越来越多，既丰富了节日体验，又让家人得以共度高质量的团聚时光。就连发红包的习俗也走向了数字化。如今，各个年龄段的朋友都会互发电子红包，为节日增添了新的乐趣。

6 现代生活方式同样重新定义了春节娱乐活动。无人机表演取代鞭炮点亮夜空，既保持了节日氛围，又减少了污染。随着现代化带动可支配收入的增加，节日活动范围也扩大到家庭之外。越来越多的家庭走上文化探索之旅，或流连于自贡灯会的梦幻光辉中，或徜徉在广州花市的芬芳气息里，或融入北京庙会的欢腾热闹中。对于更富冒险精神的人来说，世界的大门也随之敞开。近年来，中国游客寻求以新方式庆祝春节，在白雪皑皑的阿尔卑斯山滑雪，或在新加坡的滨海湾花园漫步已成为日益流行的海外度假选择。

7 与此同时，中国的电影银幕前所未有地绚丽多彩。2025 年中国春节档票房突破 95 亿元，成为全球电影市场冠军。从温情脉脉的家庭片到紧张刺激的动作片，总有适合每位观众口味的中国故事。

8 春节的演变正是中国令人瞩目的现代化历程的缩影，展现了一个社会从艰辛走向舒适、从匮乏走向富足、从朴素走向精致的巨大飞跃。然而，在变革的浪潮中，春节的核心依旧合着古老的节拍，那便是人们对新一年繁荣、健康与欢乐的美好期盼。

Reading and understanding

Reference answers

1

1) a vibrant mix of experiences
2) a few taps
3) mere hours
4) Celebrations
5) a leisurely scroll
6) virtual red envelopes
7) Entertainment
8) pollution
9) cultural adventures
10) breathtaking journey of modernization

2

1 b, c

2 a

3 a, d

4 b

Examples illustrating traditions:

One of the Spring Festival's cherished themes, the joyful reunion of families, gathers relatives who journey from far and near to be back home again.

Festive markets still thrive, providing a sensory feast for those who enjoy traditional shopping.

For those who find comfort in home-cooked meals, the kitchen remains a sanctuary where aromatic memories are lovingly created.

Yet, amid this wave of transformation, the festival's heart beats steadily to an ancient rhythm, promising resolute hope for a year filled with prosperity, health, and joy.

Intercultural communication skill

Teaching suggestions

The following steps guide Ss through selecting appropriate personal experiences for the task, and provide techniques for crafting vivid, engaging descriptions that connect individual stories to broader modernization trends.

- Start with personal reflections: Have Ss identify significant changes they've personally experienced over the past 5-10 years. Guide them to focus on changes that reflect broader societal transformations, such as digital payment methods, communication tools, or living standards.
- Encourage Ss to make specific and detailed descriptions – instead of simply stating "things are more convenient now," they should provide concrete examples like "we no longer need to queue at banks for hours before festivals."
- Introduce a simple framework: First, describe the past situation with vivid details, then contrast it with the present, and finally connect their personal experience to China's broader modernization journey.
- Remind Ss to avoid the following errors: being too general, focusing solely on personal experiences without making broader connections, or overemphasizing either the past or present without creating clear contrasts.
- Have Ss review each other's work to identify any problems and encourage them to make suggestions for revision.

*** Remind Ss to access the video micro-lecture in the digital textbook to learn more about the skill on Ucampus.**

Sample answers

When I was a child, I remember my parents having bulky wallets stuffed with cash and cards. They used to worry about not having enough small bills for the street food vendors and used to rush to find ATMs before they closed. In the lead-up to the holidays, people used to wait in long queues at the bank, as everyone needed to withdraw cash. I still remember before the Spring Festival, my parents sometimes had to spend hours at the bank to withdraw crisp new bills for red envelopes, joining the endless queue of people with the same mission.

Now, our smartphones are all we need – by scanning QR codes, we can pay for everything from a bowl of noodles at a tiny street stall to utility bills and movie tickets. Even splitting bills with friends has become effortless through the AA payment function. What amazes me most is how this technology has bridged generations: I've watched my 80-year-old grandmother, who once insisted on keeping money under her mattress, confidently using her mobile phone to buy vegetables at the local market and send digital red envelopes during festivals. She even teaches her friends at the park how to scan QR codes and check their payment history.

This shift from cash to mobile payment mirrors China's leap into the digital economy. From mega-cities to remote villages, from high-end shopping malls to roadside fruit stands, digital payment has revolutionized how we handle money. The days of carrying bulging wallets, counting change, and worrying about counterfeit bills seem like ancient history, and China has emerged as a global leader in digital payment innovation, where even small transactions have been transformed into seamless digital experiences.

Language in focus

Reference answers

1

1 rhythm

2 allure

3 resolute

4 commonplace

5 shrinking

6 unveiled

7 abundant

8 metropolises

2

1 Digital learning platforms unveil a wealth of options for Chinese students

2 be accomplished in the blink of an eye through government service apps

3 Cities across China embark on smart city initiatives

4 Modern agricultural techniques have helped farmers cut down on water consumption

5 have been traded for electric vehicles

6 have ended up becoming their enthusiastic users

3

Chinese modernization has brought a sea change to people's lives. The continuous expansion of the high-speed rail network has made travel more convenient and efficient, while the thriving development of e-commerce and courier services has significantly accelerated the circulation of goods. Along with the rapid economic growth, residents' disposable income has steadily increased, leading to a notable improvement in the quality of life. China remains resolute in advancing technological innovation and infrastructure development, which has not only laid a solid foundation for modernization but also provided the world with a unique model of modern development.

Critical thinking

Sample answers

1

The video demonstrates "the modernization of common prosperity for all" through extensive infrastructure projects like those in Xinjiang and Xizang. These developments have significantly improved the connectivity and economic opportunities in previously remote areas, embodying China's commitment that "no place will be left behind due to poor traffic on the road to a moderately prosperous society."

The text touches on several aspects of Chinese modernization. First, "the modernization of material and cultural-ethical advancement" is illustrated through the evolution of entertainment options during the Spring Festival, where traditional home-based celebrations have come to include cultural travel, cinema experiences, and various modern entertainment choices. Second, "the modernization of harmony between humanity and nature" can be seen in the replacement of traditional firecrackers with environmentally friendly drone performances, which demonstrates a balance between festive celebrations and environmental protection. Third, "the modernization of a huge population" is powerfully demonstrated by the evolution of travel options thanks to the advanced transportation infrastructure, which enables hundreds of millions to journey home with unprecedented ease and efficiency.

However, one important feature of Chinese modernization wasn't covered in these materials: "the modernization of peaceful development." This is exemplified by China's expanding high-standard free trade zone network, which contributes to China being a major trading partner for over 150 countries and regions. Through the Belt and Road Initiative, etc., China has built the world's most extensive international cooperation platform, demonstrating its commitment to mutual development and global cooperation.

2

Several distinct characteristics of Chinese society have fundamentally shaped China's modernization path.

First and foremost, China's massive population presents both unique challenges and opportunities. With over 1.4 billion people, China's modernization must address the basic needs of nearly one-fifth of the global population. This demographic reality has influenced the

government in devising specific development strategies, from initially developing labor-intensive industries to comprehensive educational and technological upgrades, and careful urban planning to manage the world's largest rural-to-urban migration.

Second, China's modernization is deeply rooted in its cultural heritage. Traditional concepts like "xiaokang" (moderate prosperity) and "datong" (great harmony) reflect the long-standing aspirations for a society where everyone can live a good life. The philosophical notion that "Heaven and Earth co-exist with me" emphasizes harmony between humans and nature, guiding China's approach to balancing economic progress with ecological preservation.

Third, China's modernization has been shaped by lessons from history. China's 19th-century encounters with imperialist powers have cultivated a deep appreciation for sovereignty and independence in foreign relations. This historical awareness has led China to pursue a path of peaceful development, emphasizing win-win cooperation rather than zero-sum competition, and underscoring the importance of self-determination in its modernization journey.

Exploring the world

Building on the analysis of China's modernization and its unique success stories, the focus now shifts to exploring other paths to modernization in different global contexts. The text in this section provides an illuminating exploration of Germany's post-World War II modernization journey. Through examining Germany's strategic policy-making, international cooperation, and commitment to innovation, it reveals how a nation successfully rebuilt itself from the ruins of war to a leading industrial power.

The key teaching objectives are to help Ss understand the universal elements and unique characteristics of different modernization paths. For example, while Germany's emphasis on industrial development and technological innovation shares some common characteristics with China's modernization, its distinctive "social market economy" model and deep integration into European economic structures reflect its specific historical context and geographical position. Ss should grasp how modernization strategies are shaped by each country's unique circumstances while identifying common elements that contribute to successful development.

This section offers valuable opportunities for cross-cultural learning, particularly in three areas: the role of strategic economic policies in national development, the importance of international cooperation in modernization, and the critical role of innovation and education in building a competitive economy.

Text: The journey of "Made in Germany"

Background information

Germany's modernization journey is a complex narrative of industrial transformation, political upheaval, and national reconstruction. Beginning in the late 19th century, Germany rapidly industrialized under Bismarck, becoming a major European power in manufacturing and technology. However, this growth was uneven and often linked with military ambitions, leading to two devastating world wars. These conflicts left Germany shattered. It wasn't until after World War II that Germany embarked on comprehensive modernization. The post-war "Wirtschaftswunder," or economic miracle, in Germany focused on sustainable growth, technological innovation, and social welfare, stabilizing and strengthening the nation, and establishing it as a leading global economy. As of 2024, Germany is the world's third-largest economy (following the US and China, based on GDP), dominating sectors such as mechanical engineering, chemicals, and automotive manufacturing. Despite its strengths, Germany faces challenges like the digital transformation, the green energy transition, and an aging population. In response, it has launched initiatives like the 2030 Vision for Industrie 4.0, focusing on autonomy, interoperability, and sustainability, showcasing its ability to adapt to contemporary challenges.

Notes

1 **The Max Planck Society**, established in 1948 and named after the physicist Max Planck (1858-1947), focuses on fundamental research and the advancement of scientific knowledge. It recruits the world's most outstanding scientists and gives them the freedom to pursue their research interests with minimal administrative constraints. This institution represents Germany's strong tradition of pure scientific inquiry.

2 **The Fraunhofer Society**, named after the physicist Joseph von Fraunhofer (1787-1826), specializes in applied research closely tied to industry needs. About 70 percent of its revenue comes from contracts with industry and publicly funded research projects, ensuring that research remains closely tied to practical applications. It exemplifies Germany's focus on research with real-world applications.

***T can guide Ss to study the multimodal annotations in the digital textbook on Ucampus.**

Language points

1 **However, its beginning was far from illustrious. (Para. 1)**

Note: The expression "far from + adjective / noun / v-ing" is used to emphasize that something is the opposite of what is mentioned. For example:
The project is far from complete. (≠ complete)
She is far from being satisfied with the results. (≠ satisfied)
The truth was far from what we expected. (≠ expected)

2 **Its transformation from a mark of inferiority to a badge of honor is a fascinating journey of resilience and innovation that underscores Germany's remarkable post-war recovery and modernization. (Para. 1)**

underscore: *v.* emphasize or draw attention to, formally emphasizing the importance of sth. 强调；突出 (similar words: highlight, emphasize, underline)
The global response to climate change underscores the urgent need for international cooperation and sustainable practices.

Note: The sentence employs metaphorical expressions through the contrast between "mark of inferiority" and "badge of honor." This rhetorical device of contrasting pairs, similar to phrases like "from rags to riches" or "from zero to hero," effectively communicates not just change, but a complete reversal of status, making the description more vivid and memorable.

3 **The story of this transformation began in the aftermath of World War II, when Germany lay in ruins and its economy was in a shambles. (Para. 2)**

Meaning: Germany's remarkable transformation originated in the post-World War II period when the nation faced complete physical and economic devastation.

4 **Many German industries grabbed the bull by the horns, using this newfound stability and improved morale to transition successfully from wartime production to peacetime manufacturing, thus driving the economic recovery. (Para. 2)**

grab the bull by the horns: (*idiom*) do sth. difficult in a brave and determined way 当机立断；勇敢面对困难

Instead of avoiding the difficult conversation, she decided to grab the bull by the horns and address the issue directly with her manager.

Note: Transition words like "thus" are essential in writing to show logical connections between ideas. Similar words include "therefore" (more formal, emphasizing logical conclusion), "consequently" (stressing direct outcomes), and "as a result" (more neutral).

5 Building on this newfound stability, the FRG's integration into European economic structures further accelerated its modernization, enhancing the global prominence of the "Made in Germany" label. (Para. 4)

Note: Participle phrases are effective in helping connect ideas and show relationships between actions. In this sentence, it is used to discuss context (Building on …) and result (enhancing the global prominence of …).

Other examples in the text include "marking a significant milestone" (Para. 3) and "boasting numerous Nobel Prize laureates" (Para. 6), which add detail and context while maintaining sentence flow.

6 A prime example of this success is the rapid expansion of German infrastructure construction companies into international markets. (Para. 5)

prime:

a.

1) (*only before noun*) most important 最重要的；首要的

Education is a prime factor in determining a country's future success.

2) of the very best quality or kind 质量最好的；一流的

This location is in a prime spot for attracting tourists, offering stunning views and easy access to the city center.

n. [sing.] the time in your life when you are strongest and most active 全盛时期；盛年；壮年时期

The scientist was awarded the Nobel Prize during the prime of her career.

Notes: Writers can introduce examples in various ways to maintain reader interest and create smooth transitions. Common expressions include "for instance," "such as," "be reflected in," and "like."

7 Despite having only a fraction of their assets remaining after World War II, these companies soon bounced back and extended their operations globally. (Para. 5)

a fraction of: a small part or amount of sth. 小部分；片段；些微；少量

The new electric vehicle consumes only a fraction of the energy required by traditional gasoline-powered cars, making it more environmentally friendly.

bounce back: return quickly to your usual state after a difficult situation or event 恢复元气；重振旗鼓

Despite initial setbacks in the market, the company's stock prices bounced back strongly in the fourth quarter.

8 The blend of economic integration and industrial revival marked Germany's emergence as a powerhouse within Europe, making the "Made in Germany" label synonymous with reliability and widespread acclaim. (Para. 5)

powerhouse: *n.* [C] a country, organization, or person with a lot of influence, power, or energy 强国；权势集团；显贵

Singapore has become a powerhouse of technological advancement, attracting top talent and driving innovation on a global scale.

be synonymous with: be closely connected with 与…相同；与…近似

For many, the name Shakespeare is synonymous with literary excellence and timeless storytelling.

9 From its humble beginnings as a mark for counterfeit goods, "Made in Germany" has become a symbol of excellence, epitomizing the country's extraordinary journey of modernization. (Para. 8)

epitomize: *vt.* be a very typical example of sth. 是…的典型（典范）

Her dedication to helping others and her tireless work ethic epitomize the meaning of true leadership.

Translation

"德国制造"的历程

1 当想到"德国制造"时，你会联想到高质量、可靠和创新吗？根据一项最新的全球调查，这些是当今人们对这一标识常见的联想。然而，这一标识在诞生之处却一点也不光彩。1887 年，英国政府引入"德国制造"标识，最初作为一项监管措施，用于区分正宗的英国制造产品与可能质量难以保证的德国仿冒商品。从最初的劣质象征到如今的荣誉勋章，这一标识的蜕变历程是一段充满韧性与创新的迷人旅程，彰显了其在战后复兴和现代化进程中的卓越成就。

2 这一变革始于第二次世界大战之后。当时，德国满目疮痍，经济一片萧条。1948 年，随着德国马克的引入以及价格管制的取消，一个稳定发展的新时期在联邦德国正式开启。这些措施为"社会市场经济"的建立奠定了基础。这种经济模式将自由市场资本主义与政府监管相结合，既追求经济效益，也注重社会公平。战后政策改善了劳工权益和社会福利，如公平薪资、优质工作环境以及就业保障，这些待遇在战前并不常见。上述政策不仅提振了员工士气，也提高了生产效率。众

多德国企业把握机遇，利用这种稳定局面成功实现了从战时生产向民用制造的转型，为经济复苏注入了活力。

3 这种复苏在汽车工业领域尤为显著。曾经投身于生产军用车辆的工人们转而投入民用汽车的研发，创造出以卓越设计和工艺闻名的新车型。例如，在除雪车和冬季轮胎尚未普及的年代，德国汽车就能凭借卓越的性能轻松应对冰雪路面。到1958 年，也就是实施经济改革短短十年后，德国汽车的产销量突破百万辆，成为战后工业复兴的重要里程碑。这一成就不仅展示了德国经济现代化的成果，也见证了德国人民重建家园的坚韧精神，同时标志着“德国制造”蜕变为工程卓越的象征。

4 在经济稳定的基础上，联邦德国通过融入欧洲经济体系进一步加速了现代化进程，“德国制造”的全球声誉也随之提升。作为一个邻国最多的欧洲国家，德国自 20 世纪中期以来就一直是推动欧洲一体化的中坚力量。 成为 1951 年欧洲煤钢共同体和 1957 年欧洲经济共同体的创始成员，不仅为德国企业开辟了新的市场，也使贸易变得更加便利。贸易壁垒的消除以及统一经济政策的实施，为德国工业打开了前所未有的庞大市场，进一步提升了其影响力和知名度。

5 德国基础设施建设公司快速进军国际市场就是一个典型案例。这些企业在战后仅存少量资产的情况下不仅迅速复苏，更将业务版图扩展至全球。 这些公司以其在本国的基础设施项目中的重要贡献而闻名，同时也在欧洲各地的电信网络、电气化铁路和发电站建设中发挥了关键作用。这些努力不仅帮助德国走出战争的阴影，也奠定了“德国制造”作为高质量和可靠性象征的地位。经济一体化与工业振兴相辅相成，使德国成为欧洲经济的核心力量，也让“德国制造”标识成为可靠和广泛赞誉的代名词。

6 随着德国现代化的深入推进，“德国制造”标识不仅代表着出色品质，更升华为尖端创新的象征。这一转变得益于德国在教育与科研领域的巨额投入。德国的教育体系以强调职业培训和学徒制闻名，源源不断地为先进工业输送高技能人才。马克斯·普朗克科学促进学会和弗劳恩霍夫学会等研究机构已成为全球公认的卓越研究中心，孕育了众多诺贝尔奖得主。

7 此外，政府对研发方面的政策支持更是培育了蓬勃发展的创新文化。德国的创新领导力从其惊人的专利申请比率上可见一斑：每百万人口的专利申请量居世界前列。从 MP3 格式这样的创造性发明到 LED 技术上的重大进步，德国不断刷新创新标准，并深刻影响着人们的日常生活。

8 从最初作为假冒商品的标志，到如今成为卓越品质的代名词，“德国制造”的演变诠释了德国非凡的现代化历程，彰显了德国战略性的政策制定、强有力的国际

合作以及对创新的不懈追求。如今，这一标识已成为高质量、可靠性与尖端技术的代名词，体现出一个国家将逆境转化为巨大增长与发展契机的非凡韧性。

Reading and understanding

Reference answers

1

1) social market economy
2) morale and productivity
3) European economic structures
4) infrastructure construction companies
5) widespread acclaim
6) education and research
7) vocational training
8) a vibrant culture of innovation

2

1 F

[Corrected: The “Made in Germany” label was originally introduced by the British government to distinguish authentic British-made products from potentially counterfeit goods of uncertain quality originating from Germany.]

2 T

3 T

4 T

5 F

[Corrected: Vocational training and apprenticeships yield a highly skilled workforce for advanced industries. / Research institutions like the Max Planck Society and Fraunhofer Society are associated with numerous Nobel Prize laureates.]

6 F

[Corrected: Germany’s innovation leadership is reflected in the number of patent applications per million inhabitants, which is among the highest in the world.]

Language in focus

1. Replace the underlined words with the correct form of the words given below.

adversity	inferiority	morale
prominence	regulatory	tremendous

1 Effective <u>administrative</u> frameworks are crucial for guiding modernization efforts and ensuring long-term growth in developing countries.

2 In some regions, outdated infrastructure remains <u>substandard</u> to modernization demands, hindering economic growth and global competitiveness.

3 Successful modernization projects often boost the public <u>spirit</u>, inspiring citizens to embrace progress and contribute to national development.

4 A <u>notable</u> feature of successful modernization is the strategic investment in human capital development.

5 Navigating <u>difficult</u> economic conditions is a significant challenge for countries undergoing rapid modernization.

6 The <u>enormous</u> potential of renewable energy sources offers opportunities for sustainable modernization.

Reference answers

1 regulatory

2 inferior

3 morale

4 prominent

5 adverse

6 tremendous

2. Complete the sentences with the correct form of the expressions given below.

a fraction of	a badge of	a testament to	
be renowned for	be synonymous with	bounce back	originate from

1 Post-WWII reconstruction in Germany _____ economic miracle and technological advancement.

2 Singapore _____ its efficient public transportation, a hallmark of its successful modernization.

3 Rapid industrialization became _____ national pride for many developing nations in the 21st century.

4 Despite significant progress in recent years, _____ the global population still lacks access to basic modern infrastructure.

5 Many innovative urban planning concepts _____ Scandinavian countries are now adopted globally.

6 Economists predict that the economy of Brazil will _____ once inflation rates stabilize.

7 The United Kingdom's technological prowess is _____ its resolute focus on education and innovation.

Reference answers

1 was synonymous with

2 is renowned for

3 a badge of

4 a fraction of

5 originating from

6 bounce back

7 a testament to

Roundtable discussion

Teaching suggestions

Organizing a roundtable discussion in a large class can be challenging due to time constraints and the number of Ss. To address this, T can divide the class into smaller groups of five or six Ss to ensure active participation and engagement. Alternatively, T can designate one group to prepare in advance outside of class, allowing them to present their discussion during the lesson as a demonstration for the rest of the class.

Prepare for the discussion

- T should provide clear guidelines in advance, focusing on three perspectives: historical background, methods, and outcomes, encouraging Ss to research and prepare notes for informed participation.
- T can consider dividing larger classes into smaller groups of five or six and assign roles: a moderator, a spokesperson, and three to four participants.

Discuss and summarize

- T can begin with a warm-up question to establish a comfortable atmosphere (e.g., "How does history shape modernization journeys?").

- T should monitor groups, actively observing the discussions. T can provide guidance or support to groups that need help, such as clarifying questions, offering examples, or redirecting off-track conversations.

Share and reflect

- After spokespersons present group ideas to the class, T should use follow-up questions to deepen analysis and encourage Ss to explore topics thoroughly. (e.g., "What can other countries learn from these methods of modernization?").

After the activity, T should summarize key points and provide constructive feedback, focusing on preparation, insights, and collaboration.

Sample answers

In terms of historical context, both China and Germany began their modern transformation in the face of severe challenges. After the founding of the People's Republic of China in 1949, China inherited a largely agrarian society and had to build much of its industrial base from scratch. The major transformation accelerated with the reform and opening-up policy in 1978, which marked China's systematic efforts toward modernization. Germany, in contrast, faced a different set of challenges after World War II, with its cities and infrastructure lying in ruins, although it had retained its industrial expertise.

Regarding modernization methods, China initially focused on building basic industrial capacity through state-led development and five-year plans. After 1978, it adopted a gradual, experimental approach, beginning with agricultural reforms, establishing special economic zones, and later encouraging foreign investment and technology transfer. The country invested heavily in infrastructure development and expanded its education system. Germany, on the other hand, rebuilt its economy through the social market economy model, emphasizing quality manufacturing and innovation. It maintained and enhanced its traditional strengths in engineering and manufacturing, leading to the evolution of "Made in Germany" from a mark of warning to a symbol of quality. Both countries prioritized infrastructure and industrial development, though their approaches reflected their different starting points and political systems.

The outcomes of these modernization efforts have been remarkable for both nations. China's modernization has resulted in unprecedented poverty reduction, transforming from a predominantly rural society to the world's second-largest economy, with emerging strengths in areas like digital technology, high-speed rail, and renewable energy. The country has also become increasingly influential globally through the Belt and Road Initiative, etc. Germany has established itself as Europe's largest economy and a global leader in high-end manufacturing, environmental technology, and sustainable development. China's development is characterized by its massive scale and rapid transformation, while Germany's influence is often seen in its industrial standards and environmental practices.

Communicating with the world

Additional notes

A compelling expository essay on Chinese modernization should meet three criteria. First, balancing statistical evidence with personal observations is crucial. Ss should employ various data presentation methods to make their narratives convincing and engaging, which requires researching beyond textbooks and identifying comparisons that highlight broader modernization trends. Second, engaging language is important. T can emphasize the use of vivid, descriptive techniques to bring modernization achievements to life, such as using sensory details and crafting metaphors that transform abstract concepts into relatable scenes. Past-present comparisons can further enhance clarity and engagement. Finally, authenticity in expression is vital. Ss should reflect on how modernization affects their families, communities, or personal lives, balancing objective facts with personal insights to develop an authentic voice.

For evaluation, consider the following perspectives:

- **Content:** Focus on the quality and relevance of evidence used, ensuring the data effectively supports the narrative.
- **Structure:** Ensure a logical progression of ideas with smooth transitions, supporting the main argument clearly.
- **Language:** Look for the effective use of descriptive techniques and rhetorical devices to enhance impact.
- **Communication:** Evaluate the effectiveness of translating Chinese concepts into globally accessible language, using clear and relatable explanations to bridge cultural gaps.

***Remind Ss to access the video micro-lecture in the digital textbook to learn more about the skill on Ucampus.**

Sample answers

China's green transformation: A journey toward blue skies

When I was in primary school, checking the air quality app was part of my morning routine, as the air quality often determined whether outdoor activities would be canceled. Today, as I jog through the neighborhood park, I often catch sight of the elderly practicing tai chi under clear blue skies. This transformation reflects China's remarkable journey toward environmental sustainability.

Over the past decade, China's commitment to environmental protection has yielded tangible results. In my city, the average number of "blue sky days" has increased from 176 days in 2013 to over 280 days in 2022. The improvement isn't just about statistics – it has led to the return of swallows to urban areas and the revival of native plants in our community

gardens. The transformation extends beyond air quality; our community now sorts garbage meticulously, solar panels gleam on rooftops, and electric vehicles glide silently through streets.

The change in public consciousness is equally striking. My grandfather, once skeptical about environmental initiatives, now proudly tends to his balcony garden and lectures us about reducing plastic waste. At school, my classmates and I maintain a small vegetable patch, learning firsthand about sustainable agriculture. Local businesses embrace the green transition too – our neighborhood café uses biodegradable packaging and rewards customers who bring reusable containers.

This environmental renaissance demonstrates China's commitment to ecological civilization, which highlights the integration of green development into China's modernization journey. By prioritizing sustainability, China is redefining modernization, ensuring that economic growth and environmental protection go hand in hand. While challenges remain, the progress is undeniable. As my mother recently remarked while we cycled along a restored urban river, "We're not just cleaning up our environment; we're creating a new way of living." Indeed, China's green transformation is more than environmental protection – it's about building a sustainable future where development harmonizes with nature.

Self-reflection

Understanding China	1	I can name the first electrified railway in Xizang.
	2	I can express China's solemn promise regarding infrastructure construction in western regions.
	3	I can talk about the changes in the Spring Festival travel.
	4	I can give some examples of modern Spring Festival celebrations.
	5	I can explain why in some places firecrackers have been replaced by drone shows during the Spring Festival.
Exploring the world	1	I can name and explain common associations with the label "Made in Germany."
	2	I can talk about the efforts Germany has made to promote innovation.
Communicating with the world	1	I can use various data presentation methods in my writing.
	2	I can use past-present comparisons in my writing.